

Buy-and-Hold vs. InTheMoney

A \$500 Two-Engine Portfolio

Sixteen positions, three sleeves, four rules. Built to sit untouched for years, get checked for fifteen minutes a quarter, and have a real shot at matching or beating an actively traded, 94%-AI portfolio over a full cycle.

45%

AI COMPUTE &
SUPPLY CHAIN

\$225

40%

GLP-1 / OBESITY
PIPELINE

\$200

15%

BALLAST & DRY
POWDER

\$75

The bet in one sentence. Two independent secular growth engines, rebalanced mechanically inside wide bands, should compound at a similar rate to a single concentrated AI bet, with a smaller drawdown when that bet has its inevitable bad year, and with almost none of the trading.

Prepared for a \$500 fractional-share brokerage account. Data as of the September 15 to 16, 2026 market close unless noted. Every figure is sourced in the appendix; several are from news excerpts rather than primary filings and are flagged as approximate. This is an educational research document, not individualized investment advice. Positions can lose money; single-name biotech can go to zero.

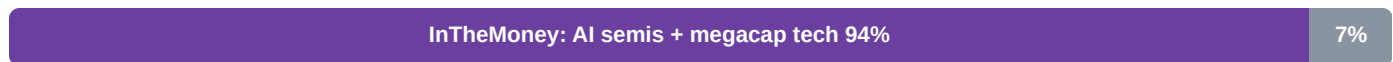
1. Executive summary

What InTheMoney holds. The "Actively Managed" Autopilot portfolio (screenshot, Sept 16, 2026) is 14 names: MU 12%, NVDA 12%, AMD 12%, TSM 10%, MSFT 9%, GOOGL 9%, ASML 6%, AVGO 6%, META 6%, LRCX 5%, AMZN 4%, FRO 4%, VLO 3%, AEM 3%. That is roughly 94% AI semiconductors and megacap platforms, 7% tankers, refining and gold, and zero healthcare. It has had a monster 2026: Micron is up roughly 256% year to date, AMD about 135%, Valero about 141%, Lam about 55%, ASML about 48%.

What this portfolio does instead. It keeps most of the AI exposure but gets it through the toll collectors (NVDA, TSM, AVGO) and one diversified semiconductor ETF instead of three cyclical chip names at peak margins. It adds a second engine, the GLP-1 obesity franchise, which is growing 40 to 50% a year and is priced off drug volumes, not hyperscaler capex. And it holds 15% in gold, energy and Treasury bills so that a bad year in either engine is something you buy into, not something you endure.



Proposed portfolio by sleeve



InTheMoney "Actively Managed" by theme (tankers, refining, gold = 7%; percentages in the app sum to 101 from rounding)

Why it can win over the long run

- 1. Two uncorrelated growth engines.** GLP-1 revenue depends on prescriptions and pricing, not on whether Microsoft raises capex again. When one engine stalls, the other keeps compounding.
- 2. Less blow-up risk in the same theme.** His book has 36% in MU, AMD and NVDA after a year in which memory margins hit 85%. Memory is the most cyclical corner of semis. SMH plus the three toll collectors captures the same upside with a spread of 25 names.
- 3. Bands sell strength and buy weakness automatically.** An active manager has to be right twice, on the exit and on the re-entry. A band rule is right on average.
- 4. A rebalancing reservoir.** The T-bill sleeve yields about 3.6% today and will earn more after this week's hike. It is the cash that funds every rebalance without selling a winner.
- 5. Lower cost and lower taxes.** No subscription, no adviser layer, and a handful of trades a year instead of dozens.

Honest caveat. If AI keeps melting up the way it did in the first eight months of 2026, a 94% AI book beats this one. The claim here is better risk-adjusted return over a full cycle that includes the down year, not out-running a concentrated bet during a bubble. The macro backdrop (a Fed that just hiked, a 10-year Treasury above 5% for the first time since 2007, and a widely discussed "late-stage bubble" debate) is exactly the environment in which a second engine and some ballast earn their keep.

2. The allocation: \$500, 16 positions

Enter the dollar amounts directly; every ticker below is fractional-share eligible on Robinhood, Fidelity, Schwab and Public. Approximate Sept 15 prices are in the appendix so you can sanity-check fills, but the dollar column is the instruction.

TICKER	WHAT IT IS / WHY IT IS HERE	TARGET	DOLLARS	TRIM ABOVE
SLEEVE A · AI COMPUTE AND SUPPLY CHAIN · 45% · \$225				
NVDA	Accelerator leader. Q2 FY27 revenue \$96.2B (+106%), data center \$89.0B; guided \$108B next quarter and says demand exceeds its supply for 70% growth in FY28.	10%	\$50.00	20%
SMH	VanEck Semiconductor ETF, 0.35% fee, ~\$66B AUM. One line gives you MU, AMD, ASML, LRCX, AMAT, KLAC and QCOM among about 25 holdings, which is how his five separate chip lines get covered here.	10%	\$50.00	20%
TSM	The only foundry that can build leading-edge AI silicon at scale. ~72% foundry share, 2026 growth guided "slightly above 40%," capex \$60 to 64B. August revenue +53% y/y.	8%	\$40.00	16%
AVGO	Custom AI chips (Google TPU, Meta, OpenAI) plus the networking that ties racks together. AI semi revenue \$16.7B last quarter (+221%), guided \$21.7B; management sees \$115B in FY27 and \$230B in FY28.	6%	\$30.00	12%
GOOGL	The one hyperscaler that owns its own chips (TPU), its own frontier model and distribution. Cloud +82% with a \$514B backlog. Cheapest megacap at ~16.5x forward earnings.	6%	\$30.00	12%
MSFT	Azure +43% and past \$100B in annual revenue; the steadiest cash-flow anchor in the sleeve. FY27 capex \$255 to 260B says the buildout is not slowing.	5%	\$25.00	10%
SLEEVE B · GLP-1 / OBESITY PIPELINE · 40% · \$200				
LLY	Category leader. Q2 revenue \$23.0B (+48%), Mounjaro + Zepbound \$14.9B in one quarter, FY26 guide \$85 to 87B. Foundayo (oral) launched April; retatrutide (up to 30% weight loss in Phase 3) filing complete. ~24x forward earnings.	16%	\$80.00	32%
NVO	The contrarian half. Down ~69% from its 2024 peak after CagriSema lost to Zepbound. But oral Wegovy is ~90% of US oral obesity scripts (over 5M since January), amycretin is in six Phase 3 trials, and a \$1.3B cost cut lands this year. Trailing P/E ~12.	8%	\$40.00	16%
AMGN	MariTide, a monthly (or less frequent) injection, in two Phase 3 trials reading out in the first half of 2027. Comes wrapped in a dividend-paying large cap at ~16 to 19x forward, so a miss costs little.	5%	\$25.00	10%
PFE	Bought Metsera for its ultra-long-acting GLP-1 (berobenatide), now in Phase 3 with a monthly-dosing arm; ten Phase 3 trials planned. High dividend cushions a pipeline miss.	3%	\$15.00	6%
WST	West Pharmaceutical makes the elastomer stoppers and auto-injector components in the pens. GLP-1 is 18% of sales and growing high-teens; wins on volume no matter which drug wins.	3%	\$15.00	6%

TICKER	WHAT IT IS / WHY IT IS HERE	TARGET	DOLLARS	TRIM ABOVE
VKTX	Viking, pure-play. VK2735 injectable in Phase 3 (data mid-2027), oral version starts Phase 3 this quarter, \$502M cash. Named takeover target. Speculative; sized so a zero costs 3%.	3%	\$15.00	9%
GPCR	Structure Therapeutics. Oral small-molecule aleniglipron began Phase 3 in July (data ~2028), \$1.3B cash, runway through 2028. Same speculative bucket as Viking.	2%	\$10.00	6%
SLEEVE C · BALLAST AND REBALANCING RESERVOIR · 15% · \$75				
GLDM	SPDR Gold MiniShares, 0.10% fee. Policy-error and inflation hedge. He holds Agnico Eagle for the same reason; bullion gives the hedge without miner equity beta.	5%	\$25.00	10%
XLE	Energy Select Sector SPDR, 0.08% fee. Gasoline is +27% y/y and drove a third of August's CPI; energy is the direct hedge against the thing that forced the Fed to hike. His FRO/VLO analog, diversified.	5%	\$25.00	10%
SGOV	iShares 0-3 Month Treasury, 0.09% fee, ~3.6% yield and rising. This is the dry powder: every rebalance is funded from here first.	5%	\$25.00	floor 3%
Total		100%	\$500.00	

"Trim above" is the single-position cap: 2x target for core names, 3x for the two speculative biotechs. When a position crosses it, sell back to 1.5x target and send the proceeds to the most underweight sleeve. Full rules in section 7.

3. Side by side with InTheMoney

InTheMoney "Actively Managed"

TICKER	WEIGHT	2026 YTD*
MU	12%	+256%
NVDA	12%	+14%
AMD	12%	+135%
TSM	10%	+42%
MSFT	9%	+3%
GOOGL	9%	+10%
ASML	6%	+48%
AVGO	6%	-2%
META	6%	+1%
LRCX	5%	+55%
AMZN	4%	+7 to 11%
FRO	4%	n/a (+87% 12-mo)
VLO	3%	+141%
AEM	3%	+8%

*Approximate, from Sept 15 closes vs. Dec 31, 2025 closes reported in news excerpts. Weights are the app's rounded figures (sum 101%).

What is the same, what is different

Overlap. Five of his names are held directly here (NVDA, TSM, AVGO, GOOGL, MSFT) and four more sit inside SMH (MU, AMD, ASML, LRCX). Look-through, this portfolio's exposure to his top three names is roughly NVDA 12%, TSM 9%, AVGO 7%. His is NVDA 12%, MU 12%, AMD 12%.

What he has that this does not. Direct Micron, AMD, Meta and Amazon; tanker and refiner equities; a gold miner. Micron and AMD are the two biggest sources of his 2026 return and the two most cyclical names in the book.

What this has that he does not. Any healthcare at all. Forty percent in a franchise whose leader is growing revenue 48% and whose laggard trades at 12x trailing earnings. Plus a Treasury sleeve to buy dips with.

Behavioral difference. He can rotate out of a sector the week it breaks. This portfolio cannot, by design. It compensates with two things: wide bands that force it to sell winners into strength, and written kill switches (section 7) that are decided in advance, not in a panic.

The fair comparison. Judge both on a rolling three-year basis, total return, including the year AI has a drawdown. On a one-year basis in a semiconductor melt-up, he should win and it proves little either way.

4. Macro backdrop: the Fed is hiking again

3.75-4.00%

FED FUNDS, +25
BP ON SEPT 16

3.4% / 2.4%

AUG CPI HEADLINE
/ CORE, Y/Y

~5.0%

10-YR TREASURY,
HIGHEST SINCE
2007

~19x

S&P 500 FORWARD
P/E

The Fed. On September 16 the FOMC raised the target range by 25 basis points to 3.75 to 4.00%, unanimously, the first hike since July 2023. Chair Warsh said inflation has been "too high, for too long" and that the Committee "must be confident that underlying inflation is moving to our objective clearly and at sufficient speed." Sixteen of eighteen participants pencilled in at least one more hike; the median path is one more in 2026 and one in 2027 before any cuts. Stocks were up into the decision and sold off during the press conference; the 10-year closed around 5.01%.

Inflation. August CPI rose 0.4% on the month and 3.4% on the year. Core was 0.3% and 2.4%, the smallest annual core print since 2021, so the problem is energy, not broad-based: gasoline was up 3.9% in August and 27% year over year and accounted for more than a third of the monthly increase. Shelter is easing (3.0% from 3.2%). Producer prices were up 5.4% year over year with energy responsible for three quarters of the August rise. This is why the ballast sleeve is half energy: the thing driving policy tighter is also the thing XLE profits from.

Valuation and the bubble debate. The S&P 500 sits near 7,550, up about 12% in 2026, with a forward P/E that has compressed from 22.5x in January to about 19x because earnings are growing 30%+. Morgan Stanley's target is 8,000 by year end and 8,300 by mid-2027, explicitly "an earnings story, not a multiple expansion one." Capital Economics, on the other side, screened eight bubble indicators and called the market "consistent with a late-stage bubble," forecasting 8,250 by year end and then a 21% fall in 2027, citing the 1999 to 2000 template of a Fed hiking into an equity mania. Both camps agree on one thing: the next twelve months' return depends on AI earnings delivering, not on multiples.

What this means for the portfolio. Rising real rates compress long-duration growth multiples and raise the cost of capital for pre-revenue biotech, which is why the speculative biotech sleeve is capped at 5% combined and the profitable, cash-rich leaders (NVDA, TSM, LLY) get the weight. Higher short rates also make the SGOV reservoir pay for itself while it waits.

September's warning shot. On September 12, Anthropic's CEO published "We Must Pace the Frontier," calling for a slowdown in frontier model development; OpenAI's CEO agreed within hours and shelved a 2026 IPO. Chips fell on September 14 (MU -5%, AMD -5 to -6%, AVGO -3%, NVDA -2%). Nothing in that changes 2026 to 2027 capex, but it is the first time the industry itself has argued for a slower pace, and it is a reminder that the AI sleeve needs a partner.

5. Engine one: AI compute and its supply chain (45%)

The demand is contracted, not hoped for. The four largest hyperscalers guided 2026 capital spending to roughly \$725 to 765 billion, up about 77% from 2025, and consensus for 2027 is close to \$1 trillion: Alphabet \$195 to 205B this year with "significant further increase" next; Microsoft \$255 to 260B for its fiscal 2027; Amazon about \$220B; Meta \$135 to 145B. Google Cloud backlog is \$514B, AWS backlog \$496B. Nvidia's own supply commitments doubled to \$279B in a single quarter. This is a multi-year order book, which is what makes buy-and-hold viable in a sector that is usually traded.

Why toll collectors over cyclicalists. Every dollar of that capex passes through a small number of chokepoints: Nvidia and Broadcom design the silicon, TSMC builds essentially all of it, and the memory and equipment makers supply the inputs. The chokepoints have pricing power through the cycle. The inputs do not. Micron's 85% gross margin and \$100B of contracted memory revenue are extraordinary, and memory has never once held an extraordinary margin through a full cycle. SMH owns Micron, AMD, ASML and Lam at index weight (about 5% each), which is the right size for names whose earnings can halve in a downturn.

NAME	LATEST QUARTER	GUIDE / OUTLOOK	FWD P/E*
NVDA	Rev \$96.2B (+106%), DC \$89.0B (+117%), GM 75%	Q3 \$108B; supply for 70% growth in FY28, demand higher	~25x
TSM	Q2 \$40.2B, GM 67.7%; Aug rev +53% y/y	2026 growth "slightly above 40%"; capex \$60 to 64B	~20x
AVGO	Rev \$29.6B (+86%); AI semi \$16.7B (+221%)	Q4 AI semi \$21.7B; FY27 \$115B, FY28 \$230B	~19 to 24x
GOOGL	Rev \$119.8B (+24%); Cloud \$24.8B (+82%)	2026 capex \$195 to 205B; backlog \$514B	~16.5x
MSFT	Azure +43%, >\$100B run-rate	Azure ~45% next qtr; FY27 capex \$255 to 260B	~25x
SMH look-through	MU rev +346%, AMD DC +107%, ASML guide raised twice, LRCX Sept-qtr guide \$8.1B	WFE spend +17% in 2026; HBM sold out through 2026	n/a

*Forward P/E figures are approximate and vary by data provider; treat as a range.

What would break the thesis

- **Capex cuts.** Two or more of the top hyperscalers guiding capital spending down year over year. This is the kill switch (section 7). Slower growth in capex is not a trigger; an actual decline is.
- **Policy.** Section 232 chip tariffs (25% on a narrow set since January; "phase two" on servers and devices being drafted), the China remote-access loophole, and the CAC telling Alibaba and ByteDance not to buy Nvidia parts. Nvidia's guidance already assumes zero China data-center revenue, which is the right way to hold it.
- **Rates.** A 10-year above 5% is the first serious valuation competitor these stocks have faced in the AI era.
- **An industry-led slowdown** of the kind the September 12 essays proposed. Watch whether it shows up in orders, not in op-eds.

6. Engine two: the GLP-1 / obesity pipeline (40%)

Size and growth. GLP-1 class sales were about \$132 billion in 2025, up 33%, and tirzepatide became the best-selling drug in the world. Forecasts for 2030 range from \$114B (Goldman, obesity only) to \$200B (J.P. Morgan, all incretins). Lilly alone guides to \$85 to 87B of total revenue this year after growing 48% last quarter. In July, weekly US prescriptions for the two oral drugs were about 206,000 combined, a form factor that did not exist twelve months ago.

Why a leader and a laggard. Lilly is winning: Zepbound beat CagriSema head to head, Foundayo is the first oral small-molecule GLP-1, and retatrutide delivered up to 30% weight loss in Phase 3, a number no competitor has matched. It earns the 16% weight. Novo is losing, and the stock is priced as if it will keep losing forever: down 69% from the 2024 high, 12x trailing earnings. Yet its oral Wegovy took 90% of the US oral market in its first six months, it has six Phase 3 amycretin trials running, and it has a \$1.3B cost programme finishing this year. An 8% position is a bet that "losing to Lilly" and "shrinking" are different things.

Why the pipeline names. The next wave is about dosing and delivery, not just efficacy: monthly injections (Amgen's MariTide, Pfizer's berobenatide) and once-daily pills (Structure's aleniglipron, Viking's oral VK2735, AstraZeneca's elecoglipron). Big pharma has paid over \$50 billion for obesity assets since 2025, so the two small caps here are also takeover candidates. They are sized so that a failed trial costs the portfolio 2 to 3%, and a success or a buyout adds meaningfully. (Roche's enicepatide, ~22.5% placebo-adjusted weight loss in Phase 2 and now in Phase 3, would be here too, but its US ticker trades only over the counter.)

ASSET (HOLDER)	MECHANISM · DOSING	STAGE · REGISTRY	KEY NUMBER	NEXT CATALYST
Retatrutide (LLY)	GLP-1/GIP/glucagon, weekly	Phase 3 complete; TRIUMPH-1 NCT05929066	Up to 30.3% weight loss at 80 wk	Head-to-head vs tirzepatide, Nov 2026; filing
Foundayo (LLY)	Oral small-molecule GLP-1, daily	Approved Apr 1, 2026	34k weekly Rx (July), \$149/mo self-pay	EASD data Oct 1; script ramp
Wegovy pill (NVO)	Oral semaglutide, daily	Approved Dec 2025	~172k weekly Rx, ~90% of orals	EU rollout Sept 2026; EASD Sept 28 to Oct 2
Amycretin (NVO)	GLP-1/amylin, weekly SC and oral	Phase 3 AMAZE 1 to 8; NCT07339423	~22 to 24% at 36 wk (early)	Readouts 2028 to 2029
MariTide (AMGN)	GLP-1 agonist / GIP antagonist antibody, monthly+	Phase 3 MARITIME-1/2; NCT06858839	~20% at 52 wk (Ph2)	Topline 1H 2027
Berobenatide (PFE)	Ultra-long GLP-1, weekly to monthly	Phase 3 VESPER-4/5/6; NCT07311850	10 to 12% placebo-adj. at 28 wk (Ph2b)	VESPER-4 topline 2H 2027
VK2735 (VCTX)	GLP-1/GIP, weekly SC and oral	Phase 3 VANQUISH-1/2; NCT07104500	Oral: 12.2% at 13 wk (Ph2)	Maintenance data Q3 2026; oral Ph3 start Q4
Aleniglipron (GPCR)	Oral small-molecule GLP-1, daily	Phase 3 ACCOMPLISH-1/2; NCT07654361	~16% placebo-adj. at 44 wk (Ph2b)	Data ~2028; runway through 2028

What would break the thesis

- **Price.** The November 2025 most-favored-nation deal put Medicare and Medicaid at \$245 a month and TrumpRx at \$299 to \$449 versus a \$1,086 list. Lilly's Q2 already cited lower realized Zepbound prices. Volume is winning the race with price so far; a further 40%+ cut to US net pricing is the kill switch.
- **Generics abroad.** Semaglutide exclusivity lapsed in Canada in January and China in March; US, EU and Japan are protected. A Novo problem more than a Lilly one, and already in the NVO price.
- **Safety and trial failure.** The FDA removed suicidality warnings this year and no class-wide signal exists; a class-wide label change would be the trigger. Single-trial failure is real, and is why VCTX plus GPCR are capped at 5% combined.

7. Ballast, bands and kill switches

Why 15% in things that do not compound like AI. Because the point of ballast is not return, it is having something to sell when both engines are down. Gold has been flat in 2026 after a huge 2025 and is the classic hedge against a policy mistake in either direction. Energy is up about 45% this year and is the one sector that benefits from the inflation that is forcing rates higher. T-bills are yielding around 3.6% and will pay more after this hike. All three have low or negative correlation to a semiconductor drawdown.

Rule 1 · Check quarterly, act rarely

Look at the account once a quarter (mid-January, April, July, October, after the big earnings weeks). Fifteen minutes. If nothing below is triggered, close the app.

Rule 2 · Sleeve bands (10 points)

Rebalance a sleeve only if it drifts more than 10 percentage points from target: AI outside 35 to 55%, GLP-1 outside 30 to 50%, ballast outside 5 to 25%. Restore to target. Fund purchases from SGOV first, then from the overweight sleeve.

Rule 3 · Single-name caps

Trim any core position above 2x its target (NVDA or SMH above 20%, LLY above 32%, etc.) back to 1.5x target. Trim VKTX or GPCR above 3x target by half. Proceeds go to the most underweight sleeve. Never add to VKTX or GPCR.

Rule 4 · New money

Every new deposit goes entirely to the most underweight sleeve, split by the target weights inside it. This is the only discretionary decision and it is not really discretionary.

Kill switch A · AI sleeve

Trigger: two or more of the top five hyperscalers guide capex down year over year, or Nvidia data-center revenue declines for two consecutive quarters. Action: cut sleeve A to 25% (sell SMH first, then trim the rest pro rata); move proceeds to VOO and SGOV half and half. Slower growth is not a trigger. A stock price drop is not a trigger.

Kill switch B · GLP-1 sleeve

Trigger: US branded GLP-1 net pricing cut more than 40% by legislation or negotiation, or a class-wide safety label change. Action: cut sleeve B to 20%; keep LLY and AMGN, exit VKTX and GPCR, halve NVO; proceeds to VOO and SGOV.

Kill switch C · Macro

Trigger: fed funds above 5% (two hikes beyond the current 2027 median). Action: raise SGOV to 15% by trimming the overweight sleeve pro rata. Reverse when the Fed cuts twice.

Position failure

If VKTX or GPCR halves on a trial failure, do nothing. The position is too small to matter and the rule is never to add. If it is acquired, the cash goes to the GLP-1 sleeve at target weights.

Expected frequency: a sleeve band should fire about once every one to two years; a single-name cap perhaps once a year in a strong market; a kill switch rarely, possibly never. The value of writing them down is that the decision is made now, with a clear head.

Quarterly checklist

1. Sleeve weights inside their bands? If not, rebalance per Rule 2.
2. Any position above its cap? If so, trim per Rule 3.
3. Did any kill-switch trigger actually occur (a guide, a filing, a label), not a headline? If so, act. Otherwise ignore the news.
4. SGOV at or above 3%? If not, top up from the most overweight name.
5. Close the app.

8. Sources and data notes

Research was gathered September 16, 2026. The sandbox could not load full pages, so most figures come from search-engine excerpts of the pages below and should be treated as approximate until checked against the primary release. Prices are September 15 closes unless noted. A fuller, itemized source list with every URL is in the companion file research-notes.md.

Macro and market

- Fed statement and projections, Sept 16, 2026: [federalreserve.gov/newsevents/pressreleases/monetary20260916a.htm](https://www.federalreserve.gov/newsevents/pressreleases/monetary20260916a.htm); [cnbc.com/2026/09/16/fed-rate-decision-september-2026.html](https://www.cnbc.com/2026/09/16/fed-rate-decision-september-2026.html); [kiplinger.com](https://www.kiplinger.com) Fed live blog
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AI and semiconductors

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- AVGO Q3 FY26: investors.broadcom.com Sept 2, 2026; [cnbc.com/2026/09/02](https://www.cnbc.com/2026/09/02)
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- MU Q3 FY26 and Sept 30 earnings date: investors.micron.com; investing.com company news
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GLP-1 and obesity

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